IDEATION PHASE (PHASE 1)

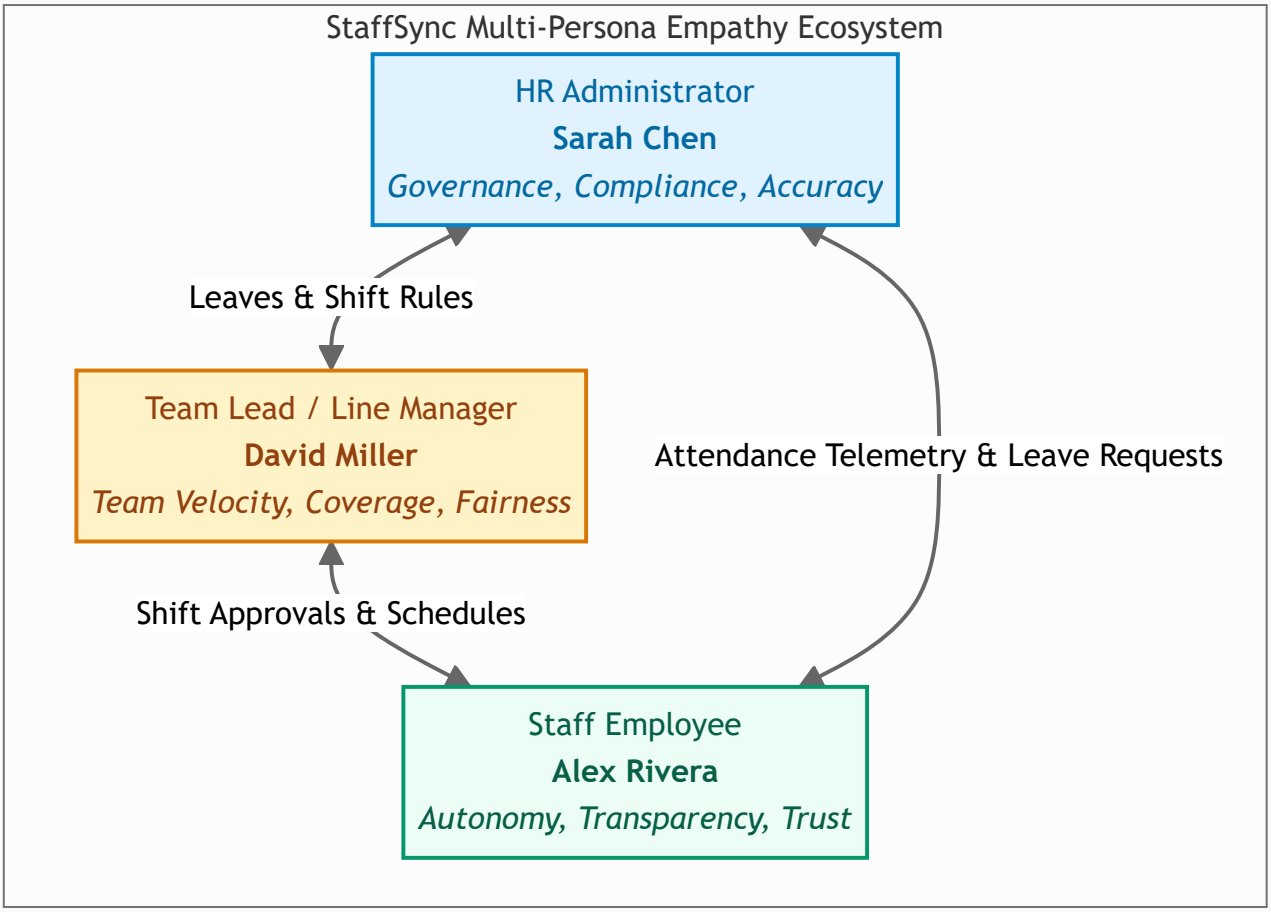
StaffSync HRMS — Empathy Map Canvas

User-centered ethnographic research and emotional friction mapping across the 3 core enterprise personas.

System	**StaffSync — Enterprise Human Resource Management System**
Personas Investigated	HR Admin (Sarah Chen), Line Manager (David Miller), Staff Employee (Alex Rivera)
Status & Version	Approved & Baselined | Version: 1.0.0

1. Multi-Persona Empathy Ecosystem

FIGURE 1: CROSS-ROLE INTERDEPENDENCE IN ENTERPRISE HR OPERATIONS



2. Persona 1: HR Administrator (Sarah Chen, 34)

Canvas Dimension	Ethnographic Observations & Emotional Evidence
Who are we empathizing with?	Sarah Chen, Senior HR Operations Specialist managing 350+ employees across 2 offices and remote cohorts.

Canvas Dimension	Ethnographic Observations & Emotional Evidence
What do they need to DO?	1. Audit attendance logs daily without database queries. 2. Reconcile leave balances accurately according to employment seniority. 3. Dispatch company-wide announcements instantly with guaranteed delivery. 4. Generate audit-ready payroll and compliance reports with zero calculation discrepancies.
What do they SEE?	• Morning inbox inundated with 40+ emails marked "Forgot to punch out". • Disparate Excel spreadsheets titled `Attendance_Final_v3_revised_Sarah.xlsx`. • Unread announcements pinned on physical breakroom corkboards ignored by staff.
What do they SAY & DO?	• *"I spend three full days every month manually sanity-checking timestamps instead of developing people."* • Manually inputs missing punch-in timestamps based on verbal trust or Slack chat logs. • Copies and pastes rows between disparate CSV files late on the 28th of every month.
What do they HEAR?	• **From CFO:** *"Why did overtime payroll increase 14% without pre-approval documentation?"* • **From Staff:** *"Why has my sick leave balance not updated? I took one day two weeks ago!"*
THINK & FEEL (Pains)	Fear of labor law audit fines due to timesheet errors; cognitive fatigue from endless manual reconciliation.
THINK & FEEL (Gains)	A single source of truth; zero-touch leave ledgers; 1-click payroll exports backed by cryptographic access.

3. Persona 2: Line Manager / Team Lead (David Miller, 41)

Canvas Dimension	Ethnographic Observations & Emotional Evidence
Who are we empathizing with?	David Miller, Engineering Project Lead managing 14 developers and QA engineers across sprint cycles.
What do they need to DO?	1. Instantly ascertain daily team availability before standups. 2. Evaluate leave requests against project milestones without opening separate calendars. 3. Approve or reject team leave requests fairly and transparently in under 5 seconds.
What do they SEE?	• Slack status messages stating "AFK doctor appointment" with no formal HR record. • Two senior developers requesting the identical Christmas release week off simultaneously. • Conflicting calendars where Outlook says "Available" but the employee is on approved leave.
What do they SAY & DO?	• *"I just want to know who is working today so I can allocate sprint tickets effectively."* • Maintains a shadow Excel schedule on personal Google Drive to avoid project collisions. • Sends morning Slack pings: *"Hey folks, who is in office today vs remote?"*
What do they HEAR?	• **From VP Engineering:** *"Why did the sprint slip? Did we not anticipate the frontend lead's vacation?"* • **From Direct Reports:** *"Did you see my leave request email from last Thursday? I need to book flight tickets!"*
THINK & FEEL (Pains)	Taking the heat for missed project delivery due to uncoordinated leaves; wasting 4 hrs/wk on administrative chasing.
THINK & FEEL (Gains)	A visual team attendance heatmap; automatic leave collision warnings; 1-click mobile approval actions.

4. Persona 3: Staff Employee (Alex Rivera, 26)

Canvas Dimension	Ethnographic Observations & Emotional Evidence
Who are we empathizing with?	Alex Rivera, Mid-Level UI/UX Designer working a hybrid schedule (3 days in-office, 2 days remote).
What do they need to DO?	1. Clock in and out seamlessly on arrival with immediate confirmation. 2. Check exact available PTO, Sick, and Casual leave balances on demand. 3. Request leaves in under 30 seconds with immediate visibility into status.
What do they SEE?	• Broken biometric wall scanners with red error lights. • Vague leave records where "pending" leaves stay unanswered for days. • Generic all-hands company emails cluttering inbox while critical announcements get buried.
What do they SAY & DO?	• *"Why can't I just clock in from my laptop dashboard when I'm working from home?"* • *"I have no idea how many vacation days I have left without emailing HR and waiting days."* • Forgets physical access card at home and has to plead with building security.
What do they HEAR?	• **From HR:** *"Your punch-out log was missing on Tuesday, so the system marked you as half-day absent."* • **From Colleagues:** *"Don't bother using the old web portal, it crashes whenever you upload a medical cert."*

Canvas Dimension	Ethnographic Observations & Emotional Evidence
THINK & FEEL (Pains)	Anxiety over unfair salary deductions; frustration with lack of self-service agency; disconnection from company updates.
THINK & FEEL (Gains)	24/7 transparent leave balances on personal dashboard; 1-second browser clock-in; clear, dignified UI.